

Mini Lesson Sample Script

Materials: centimeter cubes, a new crayon, a small glue stick, a dry erase marker

1. Measure the length of an object by lining up centimeter cubes end to end with no gaps or overlaps.

How long is the crayon in centimeter cubes?

Answer: 9 centimeter cubes long

T: Today we are going to measure with centimeter cubes. Look at these cubes. What do you notice about them?

S: They are all the same size.

T: That's right. Because they are all the same size, we can use them to measure how long this crayon is. Watch me put the first cube down. Where do I start it?

S: At the end of the crayon.

T: Yes. The edge of the cube has to line up with the very end of the crayon. If I start partway in, I won't measure the whole crayon. Now help me lay more cubes along the crayon. They have to touch each other with no spaces in between. Count with me.

S: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9.

	T: We used 9 cubes that reach from one end of the crayon to the other. So how long is the crayon? S: 9 centimeter cubes long.
2. Identify the correct way to measure an object's length using centimeter cubes.	
Which picture shows the right way to measure the glue stick? Tell why the other pictures are wrong. Picture A: Centimeter cubes lined up along the glue stick with gaps between some cubes. Picture B: Centimeter cubes lined up along the glue stick, end to end, with no gaps and no overlaps, starting at the endpoint. Picture C: Centimeter cubes lined up along the glue stick with some cubes overlapping each other. <i>Answer: Picture B shows the right way to measure. Picture A has gaps between cubes, so some of the length is not measured. Picture C has cubes that overlap, so some of the length is measured twice.</i>	T: Look at Picture A. What do you notice about how the cubes are placed? S: There are spaces between some of the cubes. T: What's wrong with having spaces between the cubes? S: The spaces don't get measured. The glue stick is longer than just the cubes. T: Now look at Picture C. What do you see? S: Some of the cubes are on top of each other. T: What happens when cubes overlap? S: That part of the glue stick gets counted two times. T: So which picture shows the right way to measure?

	S: Picture B. The cubes start at the end and they touch each other with no gaps and no overlaps. T: Good. To measure correctly, every cube has to touch the next one with no gaps and no overlaps, just like we did with the crayon.
3. Measure and express the length of an object in centimeter cubes.	
How long is the dry erase marker in centimeter cubes? <i>Answer: about 12 centimeter cubes long</i>	T: Now you measure the dry erase marker on your own. Remember the rules we just used. S: (Lines up centimeter cubes along the marker and counts.) About 12 centimeter cubes long.